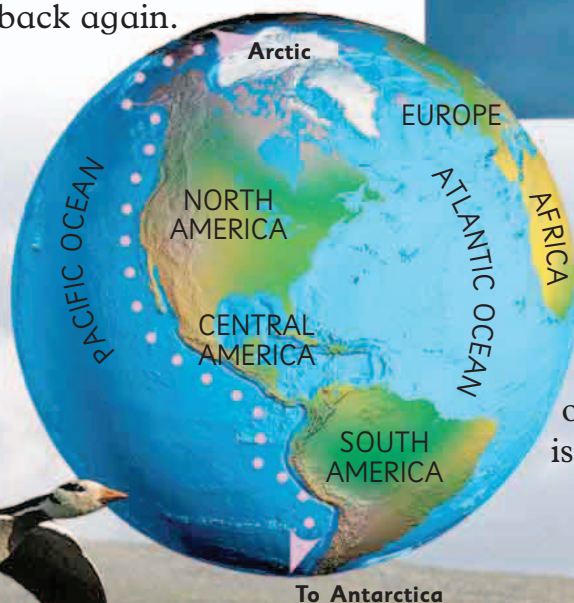


Globetrotters

The great advantage birds have is that they can fly. This means they can choose the warmest part of the world to live in at any one time.

Record holder

The Arctic tern is the biggest traveller of all. Each year, it flies the whole way around the world from the Arctic to the Antarctic and back again.



Migration

Many birds have a summer and a winter home in different places. Their journey from one place to another is called migration.

Travelling birds

Birds have different travel habits. Some fly non-stop, some rest on the way.



Song thrush: these small birds are night fliers and use the stars to find their way.



Buzzard: these birds of prey wait for a warm day and glide for long distances.



Sanderling: waders eat a lot before leaving so they can fly non-stop.



Canada goose: geese are fast fliers, so they use a lot of energy and need to stop frequently to eat.



Swan: these birds fly by day or night but rest if visibility gets poor.



Ruby-throated hummingbird: this tiny bird flies non-stop across the Gulf of Mexico.

Gaggles of geese

Each winter, tens of thousands of snow geese leave Canada for a 2,000 km (1,250 miles) trip to California and Mexico. They follow exactly the same route each year.